Social Media Skits Culture and Professional Arts Entertainment in Nigeria

Edith Ogbodo
Michigan Technological Institute, Houghton, Michigan

Abstract
Advancements in technology almost always have a consequential impact on Nigeria's culture, media and entertainment. The advent of radio and television birthed the migration of theatre practitioners to broadcasting while the country's film industry, Nollywood, started with the arrival of video cameras and VCRs. The skits culture is one of contemporary Nigeria's most dominant and emerging art forms. However, the impact of technology on the development and characteristics of the social media skits culture in Nigeria remains a significant area requiring academic attention. This paper uses a descriptive approach with digital autoethnography on the frame of Technological Determinism (TD) to critically trace the development of social media skit-making as a dominant form of popular cultural economy in Nigeria.
Key Words: Popular Culture, Technological Determinism, Social Media Skits, Nigeria, Arts Entertainment

Introduction
Advancements in technology almost always have a consequential impact on a people's culture, media and entertainment. In Nigeria, the advent of radio and television caused the migration of theatre practitioners to broadcasting in the mid-20th century. Similarly, Nigeria's film industry, Nollywood was birthed and has over the years been shaped by continual technological changes and inventions. Karin Barber noted that the industry began "with the arrival of video cameras and VCRs in Nigeria in the mid-1980s" (148). Jonathan Haynes averred that, around 2010, the attempt to make better films that can survive the aesthetic and technical challenge of being projected in cinema rather than being released on video compact discs heralded the phrase "New Nollywood" (53). The New Nollywood is characterized by further efforts to stream Nollywood content on digital platforms as it has become "the predominant way for people to experience music and videos" (Idyo & Methuselah 39). Streaming platforms such as Netflix, Hulu, iTunes, YouTube, Vudu, and Showmax, amongst others, provide immediate and continuous access to content. All these points to the fact that technological change or advancement always plays a decisive role in the production, distribution and consumption of cultural content.

The emergence of social media platforms impact Nigeria's entertainment culture tremendously. Social media are internet-based channels of mass communication driving interactions and perceptions in the 21st century. They facilitate deriving value from user-generated content and perception of interaction with others (Carr & Hayes 8). Generally, social media platforms are further democratization of media, and they provide important space for people to express their views, share information and

stimulate important discussions. This space birthed a genre of entertainment content known as social media skits. The skit culture is one of the most dominant and emerging art forms in Nigeria. Just as Onwe (109) noted that Nollywood, at a time, attained the status of the major promoter of Nigeria's socio-cultural ways, the skit genre has come to attain an equivalent reputation as the highest conveyor of Nigeria's popular culture in contemporary times. Shreds of evidence abound of skits' potential, particularly in showbiz with its provision for superior connectivity, remote participation, income earning, and solo performance amongst others. However, it has received little or no academic attention, particularly on the impact of technology on its development, characteristics and implications for professional arts entertainment. Therefore, this paper critically traces the development of social media skit-making in Nigeria. It employs a descriptive approach with digital autoethnography on the frame of Technological Determinism (TD). In addition, it engages with secondary sources from scholarly works that are available in books and journals.

Theoretical Background (Technological Determinism)

Technological Determinism (TD) asserts that social progress follows an inescapable path driven by technological innovation and a society's technology determining its cultural values, social structure and history. TD is attributed to the American sociologist, Thorstein Veblen, who formulated the causal link between technology and society (explicated in Thomas Hauer 1). The application of the theory specifically to culture and media is, however, credited to Marshall McLuhan. In *Understanding Media: The Extensions of Man,* McLuhan postulated that technological medium is important in media and cultural studies. He enthused that "it was not until the advent of the telegraph that messages could travel faster than a messenger" (90). Consequently, contemporary visual media extended verbal textuality into visual and sequential forms. Similarly, Lister *et al* acceded that technology is the foundation for all human knowledge, activity, and culture, and causes cultural changes. They stated that "technology not only becomes its own governor but begins to establish the physical framework for technological and cultural activity in general, making possible and necessitating not only further new technological forms but also new cultural ones" (341). Essentially, technology is communication that is an extension of humans to reach further through time/or space and simultaneously structure and create a complex pattern of understanding and interaction.

The foregoing implies that innovations in technologies bring with them consequential cultural changes and behind major cultural shifts are technological inventions. Lister, *et al* further averred that:

> If, as it seems, our contemporary culture is deeply immersed in changing technological forms, the important question is raised as to how far new media and communication technologies, indeed

technologies in general, do actually determine the cultures that they exist within (4).

Since new technologies can determine the cultures they exist within, it seems crucial that we have some ways of assessing the extent and intensity of the kind of changes that media technologies can bring about through the relationship between culture and technology evident in social media skit-making in Nigeria.

The Development of Social Media Skits in Nigeria

Though sometimes marred by the spread of false, harmful and sensational information, the potentiality of social media to mobilize people for any action is not new and cannot be overemphasized. Their power found the largest effect in Africa, first, during the 2011-2012 Arab Spring across the Maghreb Nations which ultimately led to holding free elections for the first time and leaders of three countries being forced out of power. In Nigeria, its first extensive deployment for mass mobilization was the *#EndSars* Protest that engulfed the nation in October 2020.

Protesters during the *#EndSars* Movement (Source: www.premiumtimesng.com 27/12/2020)

Several factors were responsible for the successful engagement of this medium in the protests. Among the factors was people's disillusionment with leadership failures; people, largely youths revolted and *soro soke* (speak out) their discontent in Nigeria. Following the restrictions on movement during the COVID-19 pandemic, several areas of social media were engaged proving that besides interactions, it presents an avenue for myriad human activities. Boredom, idleness and the lack of basic provisions forced people to not only connect on social media and revolt against restrictions on movements but equally prompted some creatives to assuage people with comic content (skits). Avalanche of media personalities pushing for wide patronage of their wares were hatched as all that was required was a smartphone that could record, edit and, with or without knowledge of media ethics, ceaselessly post content on social media platforms.

Almost half of the Nigerian population has access to the Internet which, according to the European Union (EU)'s report, is mainly utilized through smartphones owned by about 45% of the population, mostly in urban areas (EU-EOM 34). Interestingly, Nigeria particularly has no regulatory framework guiding the operation of social media apart from the National Broadcasting Commission's Code (NBC Code) enacted to regulate the mainstream media. Irrepressibly, social media have transnational operators, creators and subscribers and as such its space is too monstrous to monitor. In fact, a move by Nigeria's government to regulate social media activities and the eventual ban on Twitter in 2020 was seen as anachronistic and greeted with disgust and condemnation. Although Nigeria's major income earner is petroleum as it is the 6th largest oil producer in the world, the suffusion of content on social media is appreciated not only for their inspiration for entertainment but the space has grown to become an ever bourgeoning 'new oil' economy run largely by skit makers.

Social media content as the new oil is an economy driven principally by youths. David Nieborg and Thomas Poell describe this new economy of the cultural industries as 'platformized' and replacing the two-sided market structure with complex multisided configurations (4278). In Nigeria, the provenance of this genre follows the rising inflation rate and youth unemployment plaguing the hitherto oil-dependent economy of the country. Social media platforms such as Facebook, TikTok, Twitter, WhatsApp and Instagram serve as screen ecology of this genre. The largest percentage of social media skits is comic. This comic genre was preceded by standup comedy and sitcom and is analogous to the transition that greeted theatre bolstering live stage performance with the big screen (studio-produced films). Comedy has always been part of Nigeria's entertainment sector, taking different appearances only after historical disruptions and/or technological innovations in the entertainment industry. Interestingly, the same way sitcoms and cinema fought live theatre for a space is the same way the skit genre has come to attain the greatest followership or is rather fast displacing stand-up and sit-com genres.

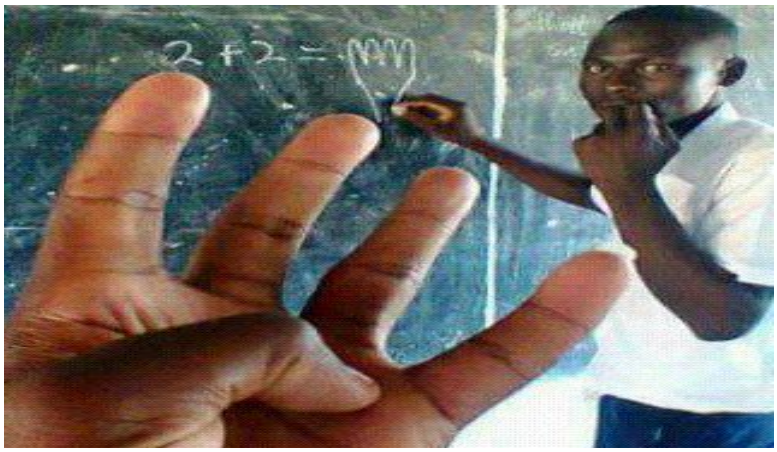
Historically, it is not certain who and when anybody started making social media skits in Nigeria. Basically, the arrival of GSM technology, the Internet via smartphones and the rise of Nigerian subscribers on social media came with the opportunity to curate content. Microblogging sites like Linda Ikeji's had existed but primarily as news and gossip channels. Eventually, clips of comical scenes from films found their way to social media and became viral and what followed were amateur videos and pictures on Facebook pages, Twitter handles and later Instagram. At a point, GSM providers joined in the jokes bandwagon by creating monthly subscription options for customers where faceless authors created jokes for the sole purpose of entertainment.

A prominent occurrence in the historical development of social media skits in Nigeria was the creation of humor around current events such as the "Oga at the Top" incident and a faceless brand such as *Akpos*. A staff of the Nigerian Security and Civil Defense Corps (NSCDC) was interviewed on Channels (one of the mainstream private television stations) and was asked about the corps' website he referred the interviewer

to the Commandant General of the Corps, denoting him as the 'oga at the top'. This inspired several comical productions in songs, dance, GIFs and memes.

Mr Shem Obafaiye of NSCDC on Channels TV on 8 March 2013 (Source: www.channelstv.com 19/12/2023)

Equally, *Akpos*, according to Barclays Ayakoroma, was a clever boy, presumably a teenager who is a stock character, a one-way thinker with predictable responses and always seeking the easiest way to solve problems (483).



Akpos' ingenuity in a Math Class (Source: www.akposjokes.com 15/12/2015)

The comical teenager, *Akpos* became a household name given to anybody, particularly a foolishly evasive young person in any part of Nigeria when they goof or choose predictably funny actions or options in any issue. Eventually, faceless characters and brands gave way to unveiled faces; this time, unprofessional comedians capitalized on new media jokes to gain relevance and sell their persona. According to The Africa Report,

> One of the earliest viral videos was an unscripted prank by a teenager residing abroad who advised his Nigerian father that he had impregnated his underage girlfriend. It erupted in a comical meltdown of a concerned father transcending language conventions, grappling with possible untoward consequences of his son's irresponsible act. (https://www.theafricareport.com/103393/nigeria-the-rise-of-the-instagram-comdedians/amp/)

The soundbites from the video became fodder for several other acts that followed. In the same manner that the do-it-yourself-spirit birthed Nollywood, the high rate of unemployment caused many youths to find solace in social media and by happenstance create personae and scenarios that they sell. *Taooma* for example recreates the theatrics and intrigues that ensue in a Nigerian family home. *Broda Shaggi* is a street tout who is uneducated but wants to prove otherwise to people by twisting and ungrammatically using words to defend his ineptitude. When anybody expresses disappointment, he screams '*E shock you!*' to prove he knows and even surpasses their expectations. *Mr. Macaroni* portrays an affluent but randy man who loses control of himself and his money each time he sees a beautiful lady. *Mark Angel* plays the role of an uncle to *Emmanuella* who instead of cooperating to cover up her uncle's misdemeanors exposes him to ridicule. This trend of creating and selling persona was to continue until the global shutdown that followed the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020. In Nigeria, like other places, people took to social media for most business transactions, and interactions and the period marked a significant turning point for the torrential boom of social media skit-making.

The boredom and monotony of the global lockdown made people to invent activities and games that could keep them busy. At first, the uploaded amateur videos depicted funny acts from different homes but those were overtaken by contents by emerging crop of comedians. By October 2020 when youths forcefully came out of the lockdown to revolt against police brutality, bad governance and corruption in the infamous *#EndSars* protest, the likes of *Mr. Macaroni* and *Broda Shaggi* amongst others had established themselves as popular skit makers and influencers who participated prominently in the protest. Years after the incident, the skit-making genre continues to soar with new acts coming on board daily.

Physiognomies and Approaches to Skit Making in Nigeria

First, it must be established that there are two sides to social media content creation in Nigeria: self-objectification and self-commoditization. Some put up content just to get affirmation from others, though they might end up garnering tumultuous following and earning money from such undertakings, and there are those who, from the beginning, intend to make money and consequently solicit and engineer followership. The first category does not necessarily and consciously engage publicity mechanisms in reaching

their followers/friends but the latter category requires and engages marketing specialists to advertise their wares beyond their friends to subscribers.

Self-objectification in social media content creation describes a desire to identify, belong, and follow trends and a longing to be loved and affirmed. Social media essentially create myths as they create mindsets. In a bid to maintain a particular cyber posture, the manipulative capabilities of high-definition gadgets help to create a misunderstanding in which the imaginary is mistaken for the real thereby producing an ego that is a product of narcissistic self-objectification. The inability to participate in this symbolic objectification, according to certain myths is a backwardness traceable to forces from one's root otherwise known in Nigeria as the 'village people'. This ego-forming process of participation in an idealized mediated image is the new mirror image. Who needs a mirror nowadays? All that one needs to do is take a selfie, upload it on social media and wait for 'likes' and comments affirming one's looks or suggesting adjustments. According to Laura Mulvey, one of the pleasures a media content offer is scopophilia (pleasure in looking) as "there are circumstances in which looking is a source of pleasure, just as, in the reverse formation, there is pleasure in being looked at" (37). Mulvey Stressed that curiosity and the wish to look intermingle with a fascination with likeness and recognition: the human face, the human body, the relationship between the human form and its surroundings, and the visible presence of the person in the world (cited in William Cain, *et al* 1957). Similarly, Cain, *et al* stated that "they imagine their mirror image to be more complete, more perfect than they experience in their own body" (1958). People present idealized versions of themselves and this highly stylized and contrived configuration offers a continually inextricable virtual culture that equals self-objectification.

Self-objectification is, however, being displaced by self-commoditization. The new media landscape of the 21st century invites people to commoditize themselves and their acts. As against and above the desire to be affirmed is the drive to make money from one's participation in social media space. Such platforms as YouTube, Instagram, WhatsApp, TikTok, and Facebook, among others, commercialized different categories of participation of people on their platforms. The ability to garner a certain number of followership, views and engagements equals or entitles one to payment by the platforms and this has engineered the astronomical rate of skits making around the world.

Social media skits in Nigeria have varied characteristics utilizing pranks, jokes and lately embracing the seriousness of life. Pranks and jokes are done to portray a character's smartness, rationality or foolishness. Stories and scenarios are built around a single character, usually a stock character whose thought, speech, action, reaction or response to such scenarios would generate comic relief. The skits have been done using essentially two approaches: excerpts from previously released films and entirely new acts. Eventually, established Nollywood practitioners latch on to the new genre to churn out short video clips of old Nollywood films. Comic acts such as Charles Inojie, Kanayo Kanayo, John Okafor and the duo of Chinedu Ikedieze and Osita Iheme (*Aki* and

Pawpaw) among others trail this path. Enquiry into questionable myths and metaphysical practices with descriptive memes of "village people" and "sacrifice" written across images of Kanayo Kanayo who is reputed for playing Nollywood roles requiring making sacrifices in shrines. Soundbites from previously viral videos are used as fodders for other acts. The sounds are either remixed into pop songs or played in the background to actors' lip-synching and facial expressions. A case in point is the All Progressives Congress (APC's) presidential candidate, Bola Tinubu's *Emi lokan* (it's my turn) which was remixed into songs. The expression was designed in GIFs and memes for banter on Twitter. Creatively too is the character of ingenious children who recreate dance steps to popular songs or mimic video clips of popular movies. *Ghetto Kids* are famous for dancing to popular songs while *Ikorodu Bois* recreate and mimic movie trailers.

Entirely new acts such as *Woli Agba*, *Crazeclown*, *Falz*, *Broda Shagi*, *Mark Angel*, *Mr. Macaroni*, *Taooma*, *Lasisi Elenu*, *Brain Jotter*, *Nedu*, *Cute Abiola*, and *Mr. Funny* have equally revolutionized the genre with their acts. The African Polling Institute in 2021 identified *Broda Shagi*, *Mark Angel*, *Mr Macaroni*, *Taooma* and *Lasisi Elenu* as the top earners in Nigeria's social media skit industry (Godwin Simon 2).

Mr. Macaroni, *Taooma*, *Mark Angel*; *Broda Shagi*, *Lasisi Elenu* and *Cute Abiola*
(Source: https://dailytrust.com 18/2/2023)

By 2022 when the social online content creator got recognition as a category in the Africa Magic Viewers' Choice Awards, *Mr. Funny (Sabinus the Investor)* won the best online social content creators' award. The following year (2023), *Mr. Law* (Layi Wasabi) won the prize. The new acts sometimes feature other prominent personalities as a mark of endorsement and to attract more audience. Other times, such personalities are featured to promote certain prosocial messages. Former President, Olusegun Obasanjo and the Oni of Ife (Oba Adeyeye Enitan Ogwunwusi) appeared in *Dele Issues* (Daily Issues) and *Mr. Macaroni's* skit respectively (Ojomo & Sodeinde 4) to promote values related to African culture.

Several slangs appear to be common fodders in almost every skit. These slangs range from *You be mumu! You think say you dey wise? E shock you! Funke! Apostle will hear of this! There is God o! Na only you waka come?* These expressions have different origins. "You be mumu man!" is credited to Alhaji Asari Dokubo, the founder of the Niger Delta People's Volunteer Force when he tongue-lashed some people for their irritable behavior. "E shock you" is *Broda Shaggi's* expression for misinterpreting people's looks when he answers questions wrongly. "Funke! Apostle will hear of this" which perhaps is the most popular of the slang originated from a father whose teenage son, Emma Kallem (a Nigerian-British comedian) played pranks on him. Funke is his mother's name and he was calling to report the incident of his son to her. "Na only you waka come" came from Patience Jonathan, wife of former President Goodluck Jonathan as her surprise following the kidnap of Chibok girls in April 2014. These salvos either mock or douse tension resulting from issues being portrayed by the skit makers. Generally, skit makers earn money by meeting specific criteria, one of which is high followership (viewership) of content that is ascertained through recommendations by social media algorithms. Equally, the network effect (the increasing engagement of viewers with content) makes content creators valuable advertising hubs as some skit makers either create adverts for products or have adverts embedded in the skits.

In recent times, some of the social media handles have been converted or upgraded to social media channels. New ones have also been created, and that altogether, grant subscription access to content such as short films and full movies. YouTube particularly provides ample warehousing and distribution of full movies. As such, a large number of producers latch into these platforms for their trades. And for highly personalized management ecology and the abundant democratized avenue they provide, anybody could venture into reeling contents through them. Concomitantly, this opportunity portends some problems and challenges for professional arts entertainment.

The Effect of the Skits Culture on Professional Arts Entertainment

In the social media space, almost everyone is both a content consumer and a creator. As such, one is both 'a follower' and 'the followed'. For example, "What's on your Mind?", for a long time, has been the probing signature question on most Facebook subscribers' pages eliciting an answer that seemingly is a demonstration of one's freedom of expression. As neutral as it may seem, a Facebook user's response could reveal several tendencies – pedagogy, crass, pop culture, excesses, or even outright silliness. And when the responders don't have appropriate expressive exhibitions, the natural, non-natural and para-natural find expression in this virtual space. This fragmentation makes people create and throw up all sorts of content without requisite technical know-how but hope to aggregate fan base. In Nigeria, this trend has a bandwagon effect. The spiraling avalanche of content creators makes it impossible to ascertain the number of professional entertainers. The trend portrays pastiche than ingenuity; a tendency to redundantly produce more supply than demand in the long run. Appropriation of

sound bites from previously viral videos as fodders for other comical acts reflects a worrying practice with no regard to copyright laws.

Moreso, nowadays, people rely more on filters and editing measures to edit and cover up professional flaws in line delivery, and memorization, among others. As such, content makers don't master the craft of performance. Emmy Idegu points out that social media can lead to the decline of craftsmanship as it promotes a kind of intellectual and social shallowness with long-term negative consequences (61). This perhaps, explains the edge traditional stand-up comedians have in the new era of skit-making. The two genres require different skill sets; a skit maker leverages technology to shoot and promote online while a stand-up comic requires years of honing stage skills through practice. Although these genres still attract considerable followership it could be argued that a standup comic has a better chance at transiting and excelling in skit making than a skit maker would attempt jumping on stage. A lacklustre disposition to honing, developing and mastering one's craft is one of the pitfalls comedians are falling into in the online era.

Social media skit makers are influencers of a large number of people, especially the youth. So many people's views about events and trends are shaped largely by information gathered from influencers on social media platforms. The aesthetic latching on slang and sociocultural enquiry into popular myths, metaphysics and questionable practices are sometimes done without recourse to the gatekeeping responsibility of the media. The construction and design of slang, GIFs and memes of memorable and infamous events and characters for banter and national discourse do not only hold up people and events to ridicule, but they also emasculate weighty issues and detract the serious scrutiny they deserve from people.

Principally, most comic skits which are between 30 seconds to a few minutes strive to strike a chord with their target audiences mostly based on current events rather than creating contents that have substance and can outlive the creators. The consequence of producing momentary content is the continual danger of neglecting consistency which could build a fan base for approaching brands to demand showcase opportunities. While a few skit makers have carved a niche for themselves by consistently portraying certain stock characters and have gotten call-ups to feature in prominent movies, the majority of them continue to vacillate and take up varying characters as events occur. The vacillation, if informed by the dexterity of skit makers to navigate and portray different roles would have counted as mastery, but it is informed by professional incompetence and an attempt to be a jack of all trades.

Remarkably, it is worthy of mention that social media presents an opportunity for real-time online engagement with an audience but this area is yet to be explored. Just like theatre has tried its legs in the murky waters of social media production, the engagement of real-time online comedy could be the intersection of standup comedy and the skit genre. It could provide the avenue for skit makers to hone their stage performing skills as professional standup comedians could leverage technology to advance their trade. It equally offers unhindered opportunities for highly talented

individuals, who were hitherto obscured and hindered by technical, financial and inflexible requirements of the conventional genres, to hawk their wares. Importantly too, the genre, apart from featuring and being endorsed by other prominent personalities for attracting more audience, does not require middlemen that could share in the payments. The social media platforms pay directly into the artist's bank account. The social media skit-making genre presents a comparative advantage and opportunities to entertainers over its precursors, stage, film, television and its forerunner, the traditional stand-up comedy. It provides content release on a faster and more consistent basis that enables it to garner more popularity and viewers in a very short time than the number of individuals who are likely to visit a cinema. This has heralded the regime of skit makers making more lengthy videos and series. But its amorphous nature with an unaccountable avalanche of amateur skit makers suffusing the media space with unprofessional content could be its greatest albatross. A combination of adequate training and appropriate honing of skills to professionalize these new acts while maximizing the accruable benefits the genre presents could standardize the genre. For now, the genre fares better as a marketing platform than representing or serving as the new direction of professional entertainment.

Conclusion

The foregoing discussion points to a regime of cultural production, appreciation and consumption that is spurred by technological advancement in Nigeria as elsewhere in the world. The skit-making genre is an art form which showcases the cultural texts of Nigeria's arts entertainment in contemporary times. The evidence from the development and characteristics of Nigeria's skits reveal the prevailing socio-cultural disposition and practices of the Nigerian people. It offers sufficient materials as other texts such as books and films for the interpretation and engagement with Nigeria's prevailing culture.

Works Cited

Ayakoroma, B. F. "The Rise of Stand-up Comedy Genre in Nigeria: From Nothing to Something in Artistic Entertainment." in Gowon Doki & Ted Anyebe (eds.) *Quality Assurance: Theatre, Media and the Creative Enterprises,* Makurdi: SONTA, 2013, pp. 474-486.

Barber, K. *A History of African Popular Culture*. Cambridge: University Press, 2018.

Cain, W., et al. (eds.) *The Norton Anthology of Theories and Criticism. Third Edition,* New York: Norton & Company, 2018.

Carr, C.T. & Hayes, R.A. "Social Media: Defining, Developing, and Divining" *Atlantic Journal of Communication*, 23(1), 2015. Doi: 10.1080/15456870.2015.972282.

Cunningham, S. & Craig, D. Online Entertainment: A New Wave of Media Globalisation? *International Journal of Communication,* 10, 2016. 5409-5425.

European Union Election Observation Mission. Nigeria 2023 Final Report, General Elections, 25 February and 18 March 2023.

Hauer, T. "Technological Determinism and New Media" *International Journal of English, Literature and Social Science (IJELS)*, Vol. 2, Issue. 2, 2021.

Haynes, J. "Close-up: Nollywood – A Worldly Creative Practice: New Nollywood: Kunle Afolayan" *Black Camera, an International Film Journal,* 5(2), 2014, pp.53-73.

Haynes, J. *Nollywood*: *The Creation of Nigerian Film Genres,* Chicago: The University of Chicago Press, 2016.

http://www.akposjokes.com/ Accessed 20 November 2024

https://dailytrust.com/top-skit-makers-in-nigeria. Accessed 25 November 2024.

https://www.channelstv.com//2023/12/19/viral-oga-at-the-top-interview-affected-me-psychologically-shem-obafiaye. Accessed 20 November 2024

https://www.premiumtimesng.com/news/headlines/433444-these-endsars-photos-are-reminders-of-what-the-protest-was-really-about.html. Accessed 27 November 2024.

Idegu, E. U. "Interrogating Social Media Networking as the Modern Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil." in Tor Iorapuu & Festus Idoko (eds.) *Nigeria's Theatre and Drama: Audience, Communities and Constituencies –A Festschrift in Honour of Professor John Sani Illah*, Jos: University of Jos Press, 2019, pp.55-65.

Idyo, S. & Methuselah, J. "The Changing Narratives in Nollywood Movie Viewing through Online Streaming" *Nigerian Theatre Journal,* 23(1&2), 2023, pp.38-47. https://dx.doi.org/10.4314/ntj.v23i1.4

Lister, M. *et al. New Media: A Critical Introduction. Second Edition.* New York NJ: Routledge, 2009.

McLuhan, M. Understanding Media: The Extensions of Man, New York NY: McGraw-Hill, 1964.

Mulvey, L. "Visual Pleasures and Narrative Cinema." in Ann Kaplan (ed.) *Oxford Readings in Feminism and Film,* New York: University Press, 2004, pp.34-47.

Nieborg, D.B & Poell, T. The Platformization of Cultural Production: Theorizing the Contingent Cultural Commodity. *New Media and Society*, 20(11), 2018, 4275-4292.

Ojomo, O. & Sodeinde, O.A. "Social Media Skits: Reshaping the Entertainment Experience of Broadcast Audience." *Sage Open*, 11(3), 2021. Doi: 10.1177/21582440211032176.

Onwe, O.M. "Unlearning the Traditional Lessons of Gender Role through Nollywood Films: A Comparative Analysis of Mr. & Mrs. And Stronger than Pain." *IJORAS: International Journal of Research and Scholarly Communication*, Vol.1, Special Issue 2, Sept 2018, pp.108-120.

Simon, G. "The Social Media Skit Industry in Nigeria: Economy, Power, Tensions." A paper delivered at Social Media Influencers Conference (SMIC), Michigan, April 7-8, 2021.

The Africa Report. "The Rise of Instagram Comedians" available at https://www.theafricareport.com/103393/nigeria-the-rise-of-the-instagram-comdedians/amp/